

Creativity and Laboratory of Ideas

Introduction

Do you know how can you be more creative? How can you generate new ideas? Do you wish to see how effectively and creatively can you solve problems that organizations face? This course is going to address, precisely these questions. Being creative in business is not a choice, it's an obligation. Managers' ability to come up with new and useful ideas is becoming more important as the competitive field has moved from efficiency to innovation. Great businesses are created around the commercialization of creative products and services all the way from fashion, art, perfumes, theater, or entertainment. This course, taking inputs from psychology, art, anthropology and management research, addresses following questions.

- What makes us more creative? What kind of situation, problems, motivation bring out our creative best?
- What doesn't allow us to explore our creativity? Understanding individual blocks to creativity and strategies for unblocking creativity
- Profiles of creative individuals and their life experiences
- Creativity in organizations. Applying techniques of creativity to real problems in organizations. Students will be given an opportunity to interact with prestigious organizations where they will discuss their problems and students will try to come up with creative solutions applying techniques developed in the class.

Course Objectives & Outcomes

Do you know how can you be more creative? How can you generate new ideas? Do you wish to see how effectively and creatively can you solve problems that organizations face? This course is going to address, precisely these questions. Being creative in business is not a choice, it's an obligation. Managers' ability to come up with new and useful ideas is becoming more important as the competitive field has moved from efficiency to innovation. Great businesses are created around the commercialization of creative products and services all the way from fashion, art, perfumes, theater, or entertainment. This course, taking inputs from psychology, art, anthropology and management research, addresses following questions.

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Evaluation

The course grade will be determined as of IESE policies. It will be calculated as follows:

Description	Percentage
Individual reports (SE1)	25%
Written assignment (report, individual or team-based) (SE1)	30%
Performance in class (SE2)	45%

Evaluation will be based on class participation and an individual project based on the exploration of a particular aspect of individual creativity using concepts and techniques developed during the course as well as the punctual submission of diary of creative encounters.

The evaluation will be done as following,

- Class participation – 45%
- Individual Project – 25%
- Diary of creative encounters – 30%

Course Outline

Session 1	Introduction to the Concept - Creativity as investment.' Sternberg, R.J., O'Hara, L.A. and LuBart, T.I., 1997. California Management Review 40, pp. 8-32. - Inspiration and Time's flow from Free Play by Stephen Nachmanovitch. J.P. Tarcher, Inc. (1990) - Paperback - 208 pages - ISBN 0874776317 - How Generative AI Can Augment Human Creativity - R2304C-PDF-ENG
Session 2	Exploring Creativity
Session 3	Creative Problem Solving
Session 4	Creative Problem Solving
Session 5	Techniques for Creativity

Session 6	Techniques for Creativity - Better Brainstorming. Harvard Business Review. R1802C-PDF-ENG - Design Thinking. Harvard Business Review Townsley, J., 2023. - Art Thinking and Design Thinking. In Creativity in Art, Design and Technology (pp. 73-83). Cham: Springer International Publishing. - Multi-Sensory Creative Thinking
Session 7	Creative Personality and Creative Intelligence - Sherlock Holmes, Importance of Imagination - Reclaim your creative confidence. Harvard Business Review
Session 8	Creative Personality and Creative Intelligence
Session 9	Laboratory of Ideas - Solving real world problems
Session 10	Laboratory of Ideas - Solving real world problems - Amabile, T. "Motivating Creativity in Organizations: On Loving what You Love To Do." California Management Review. Fall 1997. Vol. 40 Issue 1, p39-58, 20p

Content

The course is structured into 10 sessions, divided into two main parts:

Part 1: Developing Creative Skills and Techniques

This section focuses on understanding and enhancing individual creativity through theoretical concepts, practical exercises, and workshops. Students will explore the foundations of creativity, learn techniques to stimulate idea generation, and identify personal and organizational blocks to creativity.

The aim is to equip students with tools and methods to think divergently and convergently, fostering a creative mindset.

The following concepts will be covered:

- Creativity
- Idea Generation
- Divergent Thinking
- Convergent Thinking
- Creative Process
- Creative Cognition
- Creative Intelligence
- Creative Problem-Solving

- Creativity Techniques
- Blocks to Creativity
- Acquiring a Creative Persona
- Organizational Creativity

Part 2: Laboratory of Ideas – Solving Real-World Problems

This second part of the course focuses on the practical application of the concepts and techniques learned in the first part. Students will have the opportunity to work with invited companies that will both share how they structure creativity in their work, and present real and current problems they face in their operations, products, or services.

The main objective of this section is for students to use the creativity and problem-solving tools developed earlier to generate innovative and viable solutions. This practical approach not only reinforces learning but also allows students to experience how creativity can be effectively applied in real organizational contexts.

Work Dynamics:

- **Interaction with companies:** Invited organizations will present their specific challenges, providing a real and tangible context for creative work.
- **Teamwork:** Students will work in groups to analyze the presented problems, identify opportunities, and develop creative proposals.
- **Presentation of solutions:** Each team will present their ideas to the companies, highlighting both the creativity and applicability of their proposals.

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Professor's Biography

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Kandarp Mehta is a PhD from IESE Business School, Barcelona. He has been with the Entrepreneurship Department at IESE since October 2009. His research has focused on creativity in organizations and negotiations. He frequently works as consultant with startups on issues related to Innovation and Creativity. His doctoral thesis was about the process of creativity in the context of motion picture industry. He has conducted several Negotiation and Creativity Workshops for corporate executives and management students in Europe, USA and India.

Before coming to Spain, he was at ICFAI Business School in India where he taught Corporate Finance. He is also actively involved with Creative Industries. He is an award-winning actor of films, television and theatre.

Learning Outcomes

These are the Learning Outcomes:

- Interact as a company executive with primary internal and external stakeholders. (OP03)
- Apply technological innovation and new digital infrastructures to business models. (OP08)
- Build and manage interactive data systems, model and analyze information for decision-making purposes. (OP09)
- Conceptualize, design, analyze, and apply new business models. (OP12)
- Critically evaluate relevant information for improved decision-making. (R01)
- Integrate economic efficiency, ethical criteria of respect for human dignity, and planetary sustainability in decision-making. (R10)
- Lead diverse teams by optimizing resources and inspiring trust, which translates into commitment and autonomy for the rest of the team. (R11)
- Analyze the impact of business decisions from a general management perspective, operating within a global competitive context. (R22)
- Apply an entrepreneurial mindset, with a creative and open attitude, driving necessary changes with energy and personal responsibility. (R23)

Formative Activities

Time distribution for each formative activity:

Description	Hours
Sessions with the professor (AF1)	19h
Individual student work (AF2)	20h
Teamwork (AF3)	8h
Assessments & Exams (AF4)	3h

Sustainable Development Goals

While not primarily focused on sustainability, this course meaningfully incorporates sustainability-related content and perspectives where relevant. Topics such as environmental impact, social responsibility, or ethical considerations are introduced in connection with the core subject, through readings, activities, or discussions. This integration enhances students' understanding of sustainability within the broader context of business and society.

It addresses the following SDGs:

- SDG4. Quality education
- SDG10. Reduced inequalities
- SDG11. Sustainable cities and communities
- SDG17. Partnerships for the goals